Centre for Knowledge Alternatives
Job Description | Research Associate

Nature - Contractual (fixed term, renewable), Full-time
Location: Pune (physical)

About FLAME University

FLAME University was established with the purpose of pioneering the advancement of liberal education in India—an idea much ahead of its time, going beyond the traditional forms of knowledge and learning.

About the Centre for Knowledge Alternatives

The Centre for Knowledge Alternatives was set up in 2021 at FLAME University in Pune with an ambitious goal, namely, to build documentation of district-level statistics and cultures of India. Working closely with local partners and government offices, we are pioneering creation of huge inventories of knowledge about India at district level. The idea is that such granularity of information allows better policy decisions for governments, assists (even local) businesses for market research, and offers new ways of knowing about a place. For more information, you can visit the website here: https://flame.edu.in/cka/.

Role: Research Associate

We are seeking high-energy workers and interdisciplinary thinkers to join our team. You can come from any discipline, but you must be passionate about building something, about finding and learning, about contributing to high-impact initiatives. You will like this job if you have creativity, grit and urge to explore.

Job Responsibilities

(a) Research from eclectic sources, including historical archives and gazetteers, local histories of various Indian districts,
(b) Conduct fieldwork in the districts and document local stories, institutions and cultures of the region, including developmental opportunities and challenges,
(c) Extract, clean and digitize district-level statistics, and visualize it; in addition to understanding and telling the stories hidden in those numbers,
(d) Work closely with the team to build relationships with local government offices, both bureaucrats and politicians, and implement outreach strategies across government, civil society and academia,
(e) Oversee and coordinate the project deliverables across the team and interns,
(f) Based on the research and insights so developed, design and draft policy recommendations for the government,
(g) Prepare department-wise or subject-wise Reports on specific developmental of cultural aspect/issue of regions,
(h) Help organize advanced seminars and/or conferences that advance a more granular understanding of India,
(i) Develop and evolve scholarship on Indian districts.

Education and Experience Required

- Undergraduate or Postgraduate degree or diploma from a leading university, preferably in Liberal Arts (or Humanities), Engineering, Management, or Social Sciences (Economics, Political Science, Psychology, Public Policy).
- 1-2 years of experience as a TA/RA or in an academic or journalistic projects that involve research, investigation, Imagination and/or storytelling.
- Excellent English writing skills, basic quantitative skills and ability to conduct fieldwork.

Desirable

- Ability to work in fast-paced (start-up like) environment, and have problem solving attitude,
- Working knowledge (reading and conversing) of 1-2 Indian languages,
- Proficiency in or willingness to learn some data visualization software like Excel, R, STATA and/or map-making software like GIS (this will be a plus, but not mandatory).

Remuneration

Starting salary commensurate with industry-standards (in the range of 30-60k per month). As you find your place here, exhibiting your drive and passion, we will offer rapid increments and promotions.

Other Benefits:

- You will have an opportunity to be part of a motivated, start-up type environment, and therefore will be able to build and add significant value in short period of time.
- This will be a remarkably steep learning curve. Also, an exciting deep dive into understanding India.
- You will get to travel for fieldwork into hinterlands of India (if you want), exploring vast reserves of cultural and socio-economic stories in smaller towns of India.
- You will be part of a thriving academic community at FLAME, and have access to the University's resources (library, sports, cultural activities), in addition to interacting with a brilliant group of faculty members

How to apply

Email your CV with a brief note on why you want to join the project, to cka@flame.edu.in. Based on your application, we will shortlist you for an assignment, after which we will have an interview. We are evaluating applications on a rolling basis so apply as soon as you can!